

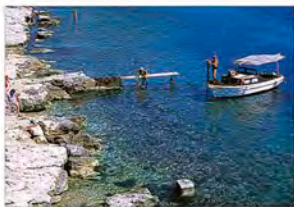


CENTRAL AND EASTERN EUROPE

Central and eastern Europe has been invaded many times, but is now a meeting place for different cultures and religions. The downfall of communism in the 1980s and 1990s has liberated the countries of the region, but has also allowed old tensions between many of the ethnic groups to flare up again. Several new countries have been created, including the Czech Republic, Croatia, Slovenia, and Bosnia and Herzegovina.

Lake Bled

The picturesque snow-covered mountains and clear lakes of northwestern Slovenia draw tourists to the area. Lake Bled, with its beautiful village overlooking the waterside, is one of the most spectacular vacation resorts in Slovenia.



Fishermen of the Adriatic

These fishermen are from the island of Korcula, off the coast of Croatia. Local people have made a living from fishing since prehistoric times. Many families have their own boat and a private jetty.

Above the inscription "Prague, Head of the Kingdom" is the city's coat of arms.



Hungarian dress

This traditional dress is covered in detailed embroidery. Colorful sewing is a typical Hungarian handicraft. Today this costume is only worn on special occasions.

Prague's town hall

Prague is the capital of the Czech Republic and one of the most beautiful cities in Europe. The Old Town Hall looks huge, but is really a row of small adjoining buildings.

